

KF22 Meeting Version of Teachings

Karis is an invitation to a relationship based on mutual generosity.

“Search me, O God, and know my heart. Examine me and know my thoughts. See if there is any way in me that causes pain, and lead me in the ways of eternity.” (Psalm 139:23–24)

0:01 OPENING

0:02 PRESENTING

0:06 KARIS CIRCULATION

0:07 GUIDELINES & LIMITATIONS

0:08 MINDFULNESS & MEDITATION TRAINING

Many of us are just now realizing the truth of KF Confession 5:

We attacked and cruelly suppressed our True Self and lost our true life.

When we notice that we are attacking and suppressing ourselves, or attacking and suppressing others, we can exercise our mindfulness muscles to help us recognize and disengage from the feelings, motivations, and behaviors of our self-hate. We can then use our KF tools to explore and reorient what we are experiencing. Both mindfulness training and KF tools help us reconnect with our True Self.

The Self-Hate Massage

Assume a mindfulness posture, and breathe. *(Pause for 10 seconds)* Bring to mind an area of your life that consistently stirs up self-hate for you. Perhaps you have made some mistakes, or perhaps your limitations have prevented you from achieving something. You might dislike your physical body, or you might wish that you were someone else. Let’s connect that hurt to our breathing and get acquainted with it using our new tools. *(Pause for 10 seconds)*

CONSIDER

Take a moment to collect yourself within your present space. Sense the air or the clothing on your skin. Notice any noises. *(Pause for 30 seconds)* Now consider this area of self-hate. Notice the discomfort you feel when you think of it. Even though you hate this thing, allow it to rest without judgment inside your skin for one minute, and breathe. *(Pause for 1 minute)*

COMPASSION

As you breathe, experience yourself as a creature with limitations breathing in a material world. *(Pause)* You are not a god. *(Pause)* As you breathe in and out, imagine your area of self-hate moving in and out with the breath, massaging this place in your soul that is stuck or cramped. For one minute, give it and receive it with compassion. *(Pause for 1 minute)*

CLEANSE

Notice your entire body as it breathes. *(Pause)* Breathe with your mind, body, and soul as you open the doors of the prison cells of your shame, rage, regrets, and guilt. *(Pause)* Allow the clean air to sweep through those dark, stagnant places for one minute. *(Pause for 1 minute)*

And pause.

Our prayer is based on Revelation 3:20.

Lord Jesus, You stand at the door of my life and knock. I am learning to hear Your voice and open the door. Come, Lord Jesus! (Repeat)

Take a deep breath.

(If time permits, ask, "Does anyone have comments or questions about this training?")

0:20 KARIS CONFESSION**0:21 TOOLBOX**

Our misoriented development often determines how we attack and suppress our True Self. If you are living with other misoriented people, you might try to identify their self-hate hotspots so that you can quickly recognize when they are in self-hate and gain a better understanding of why they do what they do, think what they think, and feel what they feel. Understanding helps you lovingly *stand* rather than react when the behaviors or choices of others feel so personal. Whenever you or another person turns away from the Idol's compulsive need to react, self-hate will inevitably follow. In order to maintain an oriented direction, you must be able to step back from the invitation to engage with that self-hate—whether your own self-hate or another's—and then endure the tension of refusing to repeat old patterns of behavior. That's why, in our KF training, we learn to endure before we learn to deal with self-hate. Self-hate will accompany every training opportunity in your process of redemption, so if you do not have the strength to endure the discomforts of self-hate, you will not be able to grow out of the pride system that drives your self-hate and determines your choices.

Every neurotic is vulnerable to self-hate. Self-effacing types are thrown into turmoil when they lose someone's support or take the biggest cookie. Mastery types hate themselves when they feel manipulated or helpless, when things don't go their way, or when they feel confused. Resigned types feel acute anxiety and withdraw support from others when they begin to feel their feelings, take charge of their own development, or sense that the community requires something from them.

All of us are vulnerable to feelings of self-hate when we compare our present condition to our expectations of what we *should be* by now. Whenever we measure our present condition against these expectations, our real progress is judged as paltry or meaningless and therefore ignored, or even abhorred. Learn to recognize and hold in your mind the real progress you have made. The record of your **Meeting Preparation Guides** and spontaneous positive observations offered by trustworthy people are clear evidence of that progress.

The Internal Parents

When you are in self-hate, your internal parents, father and mother, are your two greatest allies. These two archetypes can teach you self-discipline and self-nurture.

The father archetype stands up to protect and defend the True Self. He knows that training in self-management feels just as uncomfortable as any other kind of training, so he helps us endure our feelings while he directs our intellect toward training hard and taking action. He defends our minds and bodies from chaotic emotions, and when we are faced with the challenge of learning self-management, he encourages us to endure the inevitable sense of self-deprivation.

Building up the True Self is similar to building up our physical bodies. In our misoriented condition, we have allowed the muscles of maturity to atrophy, and now they are sluggish and whiny when we ask them to perform. When you begin working on any kind of development, you feel uncomfortable and may even suffer, but after the workout you have the satisfaction of having made a good effort toward your goal. If you are suffering or stuck, rather than looking for immediate release from the tension of your discomfort take some time to observe your condition as you endure. Then, you might ask yourself, or you might even ask a father that you admire, *“How would an excellent coach or father direct me now?” (Repeat)*

Self-nurture is the internal mother. While the father keeps us on track in the midst of our suffering, the mother is caring for our needs. She tucks us into bed early. She gives us nourishing and even delightful food. She takes us for a walk and encourages us to breathe fresh air, and, like a gentle mother, she lets us cry our hearts out for a time or mope and fuss like an infant. Our internal mother allows us to have our feelings, but she does not allow us to abuse ourselves or others with those feelings. Our feelings are our feelings, and they are our responsibility.

This week explore your internal parenting. Observe how you interact with yourself within your own mind and observe your interactions with others. Consider how you were parented. That might give you some clues as to why you treat yourself and others the way that you do. When you are in self-hate, you might imagine what advice and encouragement an excellent father or mother would offer.

Our prayer might go something like this:

Loving Shepherd, be for me the voice of excellent parents. (Repeat)

Take a deep breath.

(If time permits, ask, “Does anyone have comments or questions about the Toolbox?”)

0:30 SHARING

1:00 BIBLE TEACHING

KF Confession 5 reminds us that when we attack and cruelly suppress our True Self, we create destructive consequences; we end up losing our true life. What would our lives be like if we accepted and cared for ourselves as God accepts and cares for us?

Let’s look at **Psalms 103**, which describes God as a loving father. Nancy has expanded the meaning of this psalm by contrasting the demands and unmerciful retribution of the Idol Self with the kind intention and mercy of God. This psalm is a little long, so relax and consider just one or two ideas that resonate with you.

A psalm of David in praise of the Lord’s mercies:

- ¹Tell of the goodness of the Lord, my True Self,
And all that is within me reveal His exceptional character.
- ²Tell of the goodness of the Lord, my True Self,
And forget none of His benefits (especially when I am in self-hate);
- ³The Lord, who pardons all of my iniquities (even when I can't forgive myself),
The Lord, who heals all of my diseases (even when I can't figure out how to stop being neurotic),
- ⁴The Lord, who redeems my life from the pit (even when I've dug that pit for myself),
The Lord, who endows me with lovingkindness and compassion (even when I can't experience it),
- ⁵Who satisfies my desires with good things (even when I can't recognize what is good).
His goal is to renew my original, created design so that I can soar like an eagle rising on its wings.
- ⁶The Lord performs oriented deeds (and hopes that I will do the same),
And He gives justice to all who are oppressed (crushed by the Idol's legal systems, pride, and self-hate).
- ⁷He revealed His good and beneficial support to Moses, His ability to guide and to help the sons of Israel.
- ⁸The Lord is compassionate and gracious (unlike the Idol, which is vindictive and demanding).
The Lord is slow to anger and abounding in lovingkindness (unlike the Idol Self, which is quick to wrath and abounds in compulsive egocentric reactions).
- ⁹The Lord will not always strive with our Idol Self,
Nor will He keep His anger forever (unlike the Idol, which must reserve a store of wrath and keep accounts of wrongs suffered).
- ¹⁰The Lord has not dealt with us according to our misorientation (unlike the Idol, which deals with us severely when we don't perform to its standards).
Nor has the Lord rewarded us according to our iniquities (unlike the Idol, which rewards us with self-hate when we fail to live up to its pride system).
- ¹¹For as high as the heavens are above the earth,
So great is the Lord's lovingkindness toward those who fear Him (who are more responsive to Him than to their Idol Self).
- ¹²As far as the east is from the west,
So far has the Lord removed our transgressions from us (unlike the Idol, which keeps those past failures ever-present and full of shame).
- ¹³Just as a father has compassion on his children,
So the Lord has compassion on those who fear Him (on those who want to do things His way).
- ¹⁴For He Himself knows our frame and its limitations;
He is mindful that we are only dust (whereas our Idol is only mindful that we should be God).
- ¹⁵As with all creatures, our days are like grass;
As a flower of the field, so we flourish,
- ¹⁶But when the wind has passed over it, it is no more,
And its place acknowledges it no longer (but the Idol is screaming, "Wait! What about the *Glory of Me!*? I am forever!").
- ¹⁷Though we are just dust, the lovingkindness of the Lord is from everlasting to everlasting toward those who fear Him,

And His orientation is passed from His children to their children,
¹⁸To those who are trustworthy and keep His covenant,
 Who remember His do's and don'ts and are guided by them.

Take a deep breath.

The last part of this psalm reminds us of our creatureliness and vulnerability and, also, of the lovingkindness of the Lord, which never changes toward those who fear Him. The Lord wants to be on our side. He wants to support us in our true development, but as long as we are serving the interests of the Idol, He is forced to compassionately oppose us and wait.

In this material world that is passing away, it is so easy to forget that we are by birth eternal beings, the children of a heavenly Father. We were created for happiness, and we can experience happiness at any moment in time, as well as in eternity.

Our prayer might go something like this:

Help me see things like You do, Father. Help me see myself like You do. (Repeat)

Take a deep breath.

(If time permits, ask, "Does anyone have comments or questions about the Bible teaching?")

1:10 INTEGRATION

Sip some purified water and prepare to take some notes. Assume a meditation posture, and breathe.
(Pause for 10 seconds)

Here is our integration focus: *Consider what it means to be an eternal being, the child of an eternal Father.*
(Repeat) (Pause for 30 seconds)

The FAITH Process

Feelings

As you consider *what it means to be an eternal being, the child of an eternal Father*, how does it feel?
(Pause) Your feelings are yours to teach you about yourself, to guide you, and to train you. They can often be uncomfortable. *(Pause)* Recognize with compassion whatever you are experiencing, and breathe.
(Pause for 30 seconds)

Awareness without judgment

Gently hold your experience in your awareness as you *consider what it means to be an eternal being*. You might notice a compulsion to push thoughts or feelings away, to judge them, or to justify them. We often flush feelings and thoughts from our consciousness before they have a chance to teach us. *(Pause)* Give yourself permission now to explore your thoughts and feelings without judgment, and breathe. *(Pause for 30 seconds)*

Inquiry: What is my body saying?

Breathe, and bring your attention to your body. Notice what it is doing when you *consider what it means to be eternal*. What sensations are there? *(Pause)* For example, you might recognize what liberty or

anxiety feels like in your body. *(Pause)* If your sensations are uncomfortable, move your attention to an area of your body that is not reacting, and rest. When you are ready, return to respectfully observe those uncomfortable sensations. Breathe. *(Pause for 30 seconds)*

Talk to Jesus

You might imagine that you are leaning back in the safe and loving arms of Jesus as together you *consider what it means to be an eternal being*. *(Pause)* Do you judge eternity as good or evil? *(Pause)* What do you believe when you consider eternity? What story do you want to tell? *(Pause)* Are you afraid of something, or do you hope for something? *(Pause)* Observe your responses as just information, and breathe with a long exhaling breath. *(Pause for 30 seconds)*

Heal

God created us to have all of these feelings, and for thousands of years human beings have had very strong feelings about eternity. We know this through archaeology and ancient texts. You are also a human creature and are not alone in your feelings. *(Pause)* When your feelings bring you information, you can choose what you will do with that information. *(Pause)* Breathe, and allow some compassion to flow for yourself and for others who, as eternal creatures, are learning to manage this material experience. Help your body process with a long exhaling breath. *(Pause for 30 seconds)*

(Optional) Continue to breathe while I check for further integration.

Take a deep breath.

(If time permits, ask, "Does anyone have comments or questions about the integration?")

1:28 ENDING PRAYER

Dear Father and Creator,

We are so grateful for this time of healing and training together. Help us explore our eternal nature as You guide us to our glory and to the truth about who we are. Lead us to the next step in our healing this week as we co-labor with You to reorient our own lives for a more effective flow and to flourish in our connection with our True Self and all of its limitations, with the rest of Creation, and with You, for the glory and honor of our Lord Jesus. Amen.

Take a deep breath.

(If time permits, ask, "Does anyone have comments or questions about this meeting?")

1:29 ANNOUNCEMENTS

If you would like more support for your KF training, you might consider mini-meetings. Ask your Karis Link about this tool or email admin.